

UX designer STEM opt

A New Mode for The Reallocation Engine

Designed for international MSIS / UX-adjacent students targeting UX/Product Design roles on OPT or future STEM OPT

Domain

UX / Product Design

User

International MS student

Risk

Sponsorship + ghost jobs

The Problem

For UX designers on OPT, the job-search problem is not motivation - it is information asymmetry.

Ghost postings

Design roles can stay visible after active review has ended. Customizing a portfolio case study for a dead role can waste 8-12 hours.

Sponsorship opacity

Companies rarely publish whether they sponsor H-1B for UX/Product Design roles, and petitions may appear under inconsistent SOC codes.

OPT / STEM OPT HR gap

Employer participation can require HR understanding of OPT/STEM OPT responsibilities. This can be invisible until late in the hiring process.

What the Mode Does

A 5-step triage workflow: verified data first; prompting only after checks are complete.

1. Liveness check

Job-Ops

Existing:
node
SCRIPTS/ats/check-
liveness.mjs [url]

2. H-1B history

80 Days

Proposed wrapper:
SCRIPTS/h1b_lookup
.py
Check multiple SOC
codes

3. Funding / stability

80 Days

Proposed wrapper:
SCRIPTS/formd_look
up.py
Skip Form D as main
signal for public co.

4. Cognitive fit

Cognitive Pivot

Existing table +
proposed scoring:
SCRIPTS/bls/extract_
soc_occupation_tabl
e.py

5. STEM OPT HR

New proposed mode
support

Proposed only:
SCRIPTS/opt/stem_o
pt_hr_check.py
Requires recruiter
confirmation

Domain Justification

Specific user, specific situation, specific information asymmetry.

Who uses this mode

International MSIS / HCI / UX-adjacent student

Completing program around August 2026

Targeting Product Designer, UX Designer, UX Researcher, Product Analyst, or PM-adjacent roles

Key insight

UX applications are expensive. A serious application may require resume edits, portfolio reordering, and custom case-study framing.

So the mode prioritizes where deep effort is worth it.

Engine layer connections

80 Days: sponsorship + funding

Job-Ops: ATS + posting liveness

Cognitive Pivot: role-quality and AI-resilience signals

Failure Modes — What This Mode Gets Wrong

The honesty rule: if a script does not exist, say so. If data is missing, log the gap.

SOC code mismatch

Product Designer roles may be filed under 27-1021, 15-1255, 15-1299, 11-2021, or 11-3021. Zero results in one SOC code does not mean no sponsorship history.

STEM OPT familiarity is indirect

stem_opt_hr_check.py is proposed, not implemented. Even if built, it would infer HR familiarity from indirect signals and still require recruiter confirmation.

Historical data misses current intent

H-1B and Form D data are retrospective. A company may have strong historical signals but a current hiring freeze, team budget cut, or policy change.

Worked Example — Figma, Product Designer, Growth

Simulated run: values demonstrate expected output and decision logic, not audited current company data.

```
$ node SCRIPTS/ats/check-liveness.mjs [url]
-> LIVE · ATS detected · posting appears recent

$ proposed h1b_lookup.py across SOC set
-> Historical signal to be checked across multiple
SOCs

$ proposed formd_lookup.py --months 18
-> Stability requires current-context interpretation

$ proposed cognitive_score.py --soc [code]
-> Strong if role includes product judgment +
experimentation

$ proposed stem_opt_hr_check.py
-> NOT IMPLEMENTED · recruiter confirmation required
```

Verified if run succeeds

Posting liveness
ATS provider
H-1B lookup after dataset
query
Form D filing if found

Inferred

Cognitive fit
SOC title mapping
STEM OPT HR familiarity
Role priority

Priority decision

Apply now - but confirm OPT/STEM OPT policy with
recruiter before deep portfolio customization.

One Thing I Learned

STEM OPT changes the shape of the risk - not the size.

A longer work-authorization runway reduces immediate time pressure, but it introduces a new blind spot:

Does the employer understand and support the employer-side process?

Best proposed addition

SCRIPTS/opt/stem_opt_hr_check
.py

Best manual follow-up

Ask recruiter about OPT / STEM
OPT support early

Best decision rule

Do not customize deeply until
core risks are checked